
Architecture Decision Record

Golden Path Platform - Shared Engineering Ecosystem

Version: 0.1.0

Date: 2024-05-20

Author: Platform Engineering

Status: Approved

Classification: Internal

This document contains architectural decisions for the Golden Path Developer Experience Platform. It addresses homologation, scalability, and shift-left strategies for 10+ engineering teams.

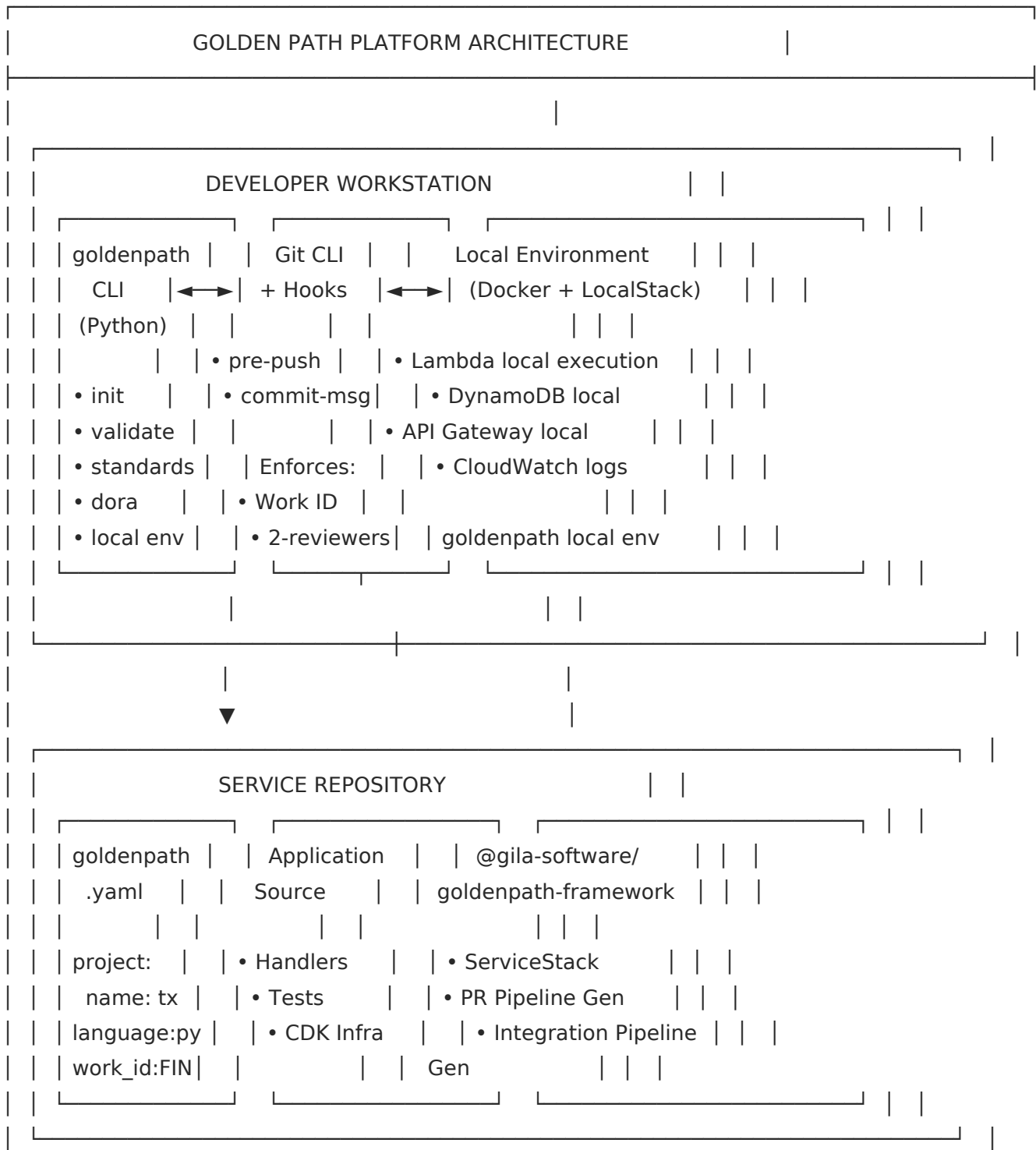
Architecture Decision Record (ADR)

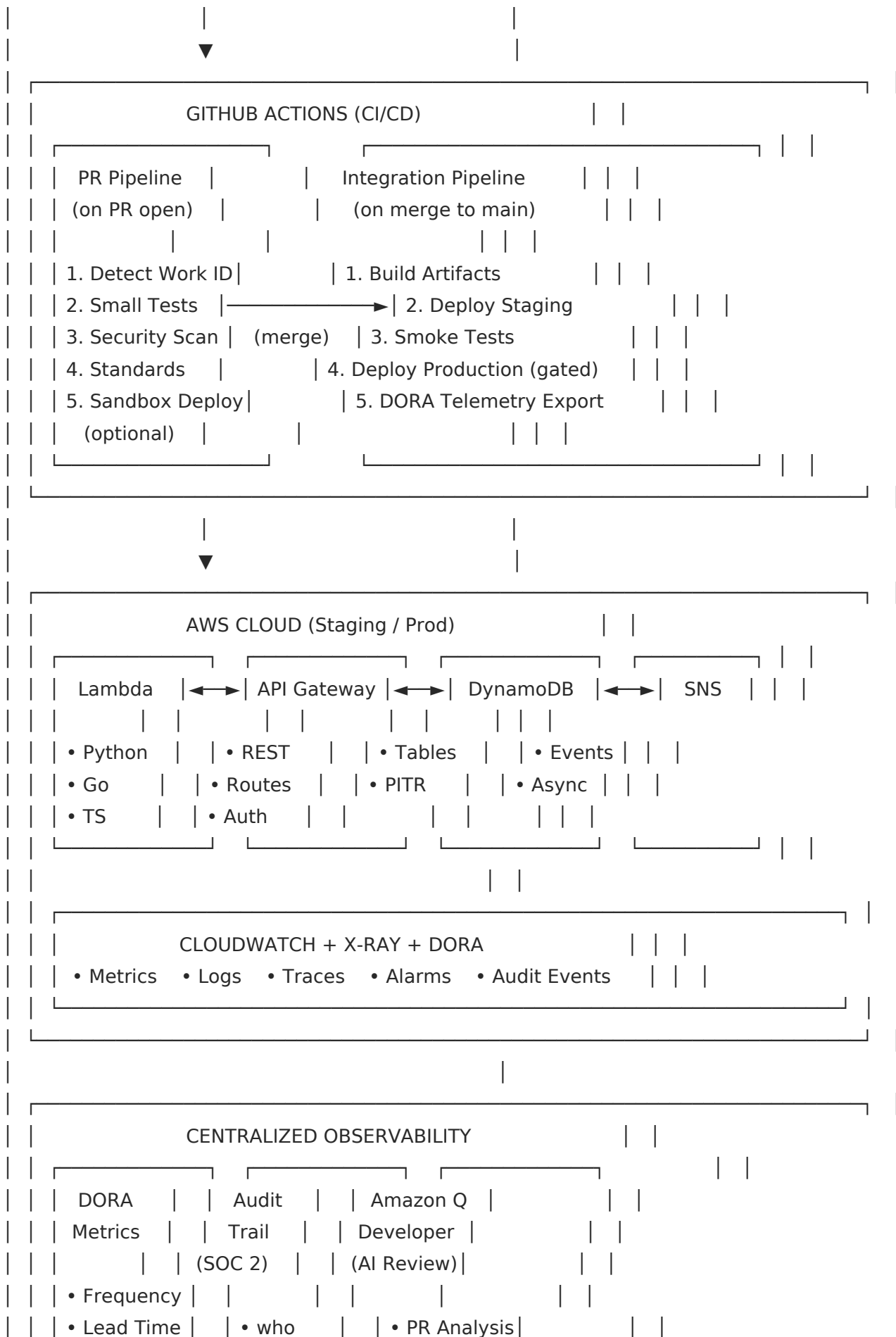
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1. Architecture Diagram





3. Scalability & Bottleneck Avoidance

How does the platform team avoid becoming a bottleneck for custom pipeline features?

Extensibility by Design

The Framework uses composition over inheritance:

```
// Teams extend, they don't modify core
class PaymentStack extends ServiceStack {
  constructor(scope, id, props) {
    super(scope, id, props);
  }
  // Add team-specific resources
  this.addPaymentProcessor();
}
```

Self-Service Patterns

Need	Self-Service Mechanism	Platform Touchpoint
Custom Lambda env vars	HandlerDefinition.environment	None
Additional API routes	ApiRoute[] array	None
New test step	Override testCommand	None
Custom alarm threshold	Stack props	None
New pipeline stage	Submit RFC + PR	Review only
New language runtime	Submit RFC + PR	Review + merge
Core framework bug	GitHub Issue	Platform fixes

Plugin Architecture (Future)

```
packages/
goldenpath-core/      # Stable, rarely changes
goldenpath-plugin-ml/  # ML team extension
goldenpath-plugin-data/ # Data team extension
```

Teams own their plugins. Platform owns the core contract.

Decentralized Decision Making

- Lightweight changes (< 2 files, no API change): Team self-merges
- Standard changes (new feature): 1 Trusted Committer review
- Heavyweight changes (breaking): Steering Committee

4. Shift-Left Strategy

How do we reduce the time between defect introduction and detection?

Validation Layers

SHIFT-LEFT VALIDATION LAYERS	
Layer 1: EDITOR / IDE	
• goldenpath.yaml schema validation	
• Work ID linting in commit messages	
• Type checking (mypy, tsc)	
▼	
Layer 2: PRE-COMMIT	
• commit-msg hook: Work ID enforcement	
• Formatting checks (ruff, prettier)	
▼	
Layer 3: PRE-PUSH	
• pre-push hook:	
- Standards check	
- Unit tests	
- Security scan (trufflehog)	
▼	
Layer 4: PR PIPELINE (GitHub Actions)	
• Small tests (fast feedback: < 5 min)	
• Property-based tests	
• API contract validation	
• Dependency vulnerability scan	
• Golden Path standards check	
▼	
Layer 5: INTEGRATION PIPELINE	
• Full integration tests	
• Smoke tests in staging	
• Production deployment (gated)	
▼	
Layer 6: PRODUCTION	
• CloudWatch alarms	
• X-Ray distributed tracing	
• Automatic rollback on error rate threshold	
• DORA failure event emission	

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Feedback Loop Metrics

Stage	Target Time	Detection Rate
IDE/Editor	Real-time	15% of defects
Pre-commit	< 1s	10% of defects
Pre-push	< 2 min	30% of defects
PR Pipeline	< 5 min	35% of defects
Integration	< 15 min	9% of defects
Production	< 5 min MTTR	1% of defects

AI-Assisted Review (Amazon Q Developer)

Amazon Q Developer provides automated PR analysis:

- Security vulnerability detection
- Performance anti-pattern identification
- Best practice recommendations
- Code quality scoring

This acts as an additional review layer before human reviewers, catching issues that static analysis misses.

Local Environment Parity

LocalStack ensures the local environment mirrors production:

```
# docker-compose.local.yml
services:
  localstack:
    image: localstack/localstack
    environment:
      - SERVICES=lambda,apigateway,dynamodb,sns,sqs
```

This eliminates the "works on my machine" class of defects detected only in staging.

Decision Log

ID	Decision	Rationale	Status
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ADR-001	Python for CLI	Team expertise, rich ecosystem, uv packaging	Accepted
ADR-002	TypeScript for Framework	CDK is TS-first, type-safe workflows, pnpm	Accepted
ADR-003	uv over pip	Modern, fast, reproducible, no venv management	Accepted
ADR-004	pnpm over npm	Monorepo support, disk efficient, strict peers	Accepted
ADR-005	LocalStack for local dev	AWS parity, no cloud costs, fast feedback	Accepted
ADR-006	JSONL for DORA events	Append-only, streamable, grep-friendly	Accepted
ADR-007	OIDC for AWS auth	No long-lived secrets, GitHub-native, secure	Accepted

End of ADR